



CABS DRDO AUDITOR

Audit Checklist Reference

113 checks across 15 categories

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DEFENCE RESEARCH & DEVELOPMENT ORGANISATION
MINISTRY OF DEFENCE
NEW DELHI

System & Hardware

23 checks

[INFO] **SYS-001** **Operating System Version**

Report the installed Windows edition/caption.

[INFO] **SYS-002** **Operating System Build**

Report the Windows build number.

[INFO] **SYS-003** **System Architecture**

Report the OS architecture (x64/ARM64).

[INFO] **SYS-004** **Computer Name**

Report the host name and domain/workgroup membership.

[INFO] **SYS-005** **CPU**

Report the processor model and core count.

[INFO] **SYS-006** **Installed RAM**

Report total installed physical memory.

[INFO] **SYS-007** **Storage Volumes**

Report fixed storage volumes and free space.

[INFO] **SYS-008** **Firmware Type (UEFI/Legacy)**

Report whether the system boots via UEFI or legacy BIOS.

[HIGH] **SYS-009** **Secure Boot Enabled**

Secure Boot should be enabled to prevent unauthorized boot-time code from running.

[MEDIUM] **SYS-010** **TPM Ready**

A present, enabled, and initialized TPM is required for BitLocker and modern platform security features.

[INFO] **SYS-011** **System Uptime**

Report time since last boot.

[INFO] **SYS-012** **Primary IPv4 Address**

Report the system's primary IPv4 address (the interface with a default gateway).

[INFO] **SYS-013** **Primary MAC Address**

Report the MAC address of the system's primary network adapter (the interface with a default gateway).

[INFO] **SYS-014** **System Serial Number**

Report the system's hardware serial number, as recorded in firmware.

[INFO] **SYS-015** **BIOS Version**

Report the system's BIOS/firmware version.

[INFO] SYS-016 Windows Directory

Report the path Windows is installed into.

[INFO] SYS-017 System Directory

Report the path to the Windows system directory (System32).

[INFO] SYS-018 Machine Architecture

Report the system's processor architecture identifier (e.g. AMD64, ARM64).

[INFO] SYS-019 Connectivity

Report the active network connection's profile name and status.

[INFO] SYS-020 Network Interface

Report the name of the system's primary network interface (the interface with a default gateway).

[INFO] SYS-021 WiFi Interface

Report the name of the wireless (802.11) network interface, if one is present.

[INFO] SYS-022 OS Install Date

Report the date Windows was originally installed on this system.

[INFO] SYS-023 Domain / Workgroup

Report the domain (or workgroup) this system is joined to.

Users & Account Management

6 checks

[INFO] **USR-001** **Local User Accounts**

Report all local user accounts.

[HIGH] **USR-002** **Guest Account Disabled**

The built-in Guest account should be disabled to prevent anonymous local access.

[CRITICAL] **USR-003** **Accounts With No Password Required**

No local account should be configured to allow a blank password.

[MEDIUM] **USR-004** **Administrators Group Membership Count**

The local Administrators group should contain only the accounts that genuinely need administrative rights.

[LOW] **USR-005** **Accounts Inactive > 90 Days**

Local accounts unused for a long period should be disabled or removed.

[MEDIUM] **USR-006** **Built-in Administrator Account Disabled**

The built-in Administrator account (well-known SID suffix -500) should be disabled in favor of a named administrative account.

Authentication & Access Control

10 checks

[HIGH] **AUTH-001** **Minimum Password Length**

Passwords should meet a minimum length to resist brute-force and guessing attacks.

[HIGH] **AUTH-002** **Password Complexity Required**

Password complexity requirements reduce the risk of trivially guessable passwords.

[MEDIUM] **AUTH-003** **Maximum Password Age**

Passwords should expire periodically, but not be set to never expire.

[MEDIUM] **AUTH-004** **Password History Size**

Preventing password reuse reduces the effectiveness of credential replay.

[HIGH] **AUTH-005** **Account Lockout Threshold**

Locking accounts after a small number of failed attempts slows brute-force attacks.

[MEDIUM] **AUTH-006** **Account Lockout Duration**

Locked accounts should remain locked long enough to blunt automated retry attacks.

[CRITICAL] **AUTH-007** **User Account Control (UAC) Enabled**

UAC is a core defense against unauthorized privilege escalation and should never be disabled.

[HIGH] **AUTH-008** **UAC Consent Prompt Behavior for Administrators**

Administrators should be prompted for consent on the secure desktop before elevation.

[HIGH] **AUTH-009** **Automatic Screen Lock Configured**

The workstation should automatically lock after a period of inactivity to prevent unauthorized physical access when left unattended. Checked via the machine-wide 'Interactive logon: Machine inactivity limit' policy first (always enforces a password-protected lock when set), falling back to a password-protected screen saver (an active-but-insecure screen saver does not count, since it does not require a password on resume).

[MEDIUM] **AUTH-010** **Automatic Screen Lock Timeout**

When an automatic lock is configured, a short inactivity timeout limits how long an unattended, unlocked session is exposed.

Windows Security

10 checks

[CRITICAL] SEC-001 Defender Real-Time Protection

Real-time protection is Defender's primary on-access malware defense and should always be enabled.

[CRITICAL] SEC-002 Defender Antivirus Enabled

The antivirus engine itself should be active (unless a third-party AV is legitimately in control).

[MEDIUM] SEC-003 Defender Cloud-Delivered Protection

Cloud-delivered protection (MAPS) improves detection of new/emerging threats.

[MEDIUM] SEC-004 Defender Signature Age

Outdated malware signatures reduce detection effectiveness.

[HIGH] SEC-005 Defender Tamper Protection

Tamper Protection prevents malware or unauthorized users from disabling Defender.

[INFO] SEC-008 Defender Signature Last Updated Date

Report the timestamp of the most recent Defender security intelligence (signature) update. Companion informational check to SEC-004, which reports the age of that same timestamp in days.

[INFO] SEC-009 Defender Last Scan Date

Report the completion timestamp of the most recent Defender quick or full scan.

[MEDIUM] SEC-010 Defender Scan Recency

A system that has not been scanned recently may harbor malware undetected even with real-time protection enabled.

[MEDIUM] SEC-006 SmartScreen Enabled

SmartScreen helps block known malicious apps and files. Checked via per-user (HKCU Explorer) and policy (HKLM) registry overrides; if neither is present, Windows does not persist this setting anywhere until changed from default (confirmed live), so absence is reported as Microsoft's documented on-by-default state rather than as unverifiable.

[INFO] SEC-007 Registered Antivirus Products

Report all antivirus products registered with Windows Security Center. This is informational: Security Center's productState value is an undocumented bitmask, so this tool lists registered product names for the reviewer's own judgment rather than decoding an unofficial encoding into a pass/fail claim. On systems with an active third-party antivirus, Microsoft Defender is expected to appear passive/stopped in the checks above by design ? this list gives that context.

Firewall & Network Security

14 checks

[HIGH] **NET-001** **Domain Firewall Profile Enabled**

Windows Firewall should be enabled on the Domain profile.

[HIGH] **NET-002** **Private Firewall Profile Enabled**

Windows Firewall should be enabled on the Private profile.

[CRITICAL] **NET-003** **Public Firewall Profile Enabled**

Windows Firewall should be enabled on the Public profile, which faces the least trusted networks.

[MEDIUM] **NET-004** **High-Risk Ports Listening**

Legacy, unencrypted, or commonly abused services (e.g. Telnet 23, FTP 21) should not be listening.

[INFO] **NET-005** **Network Connection Profiles**

Report each network adapter's connection category (Public/Private/Domain).

[INFO] **NET-006** **DNS Servers Configured**

Report configured DNS servers for each adapter.

[LOW] **NET-007** **Proxy Configured**

An unexpected proxy configuration can indicate unauthorized traffic interception.

[MEDIUM] **NET-008** **Wireless Network Interface Disabled**

Disabling wireless (Wi-Fi) network adapters when not needed reduces network attack surface, particularly on systems that should only connect via wired/managed networks. Advisory: only meaningful when a wireless adapter is present, and many systems legitimately need Wi-Fi.

[INFO] **NET-009** **Established TCP Connections**

Report currently established TCP connections (local/remote endpoint and owning process).

[INFO] **NET-010** **UDP Endpoints**

Report active UDP listening endpoints.

[INFO] **NET-011** **All Listening TCP Ports**

Report every listening TCP port and its owning process, not just the high-risk subset scored by NET-004.

[MEDIUM] **NET-012** **Excessive Established Connections**

A large number of simultaneous established TCP connections can indicate unexpected network activity (e.g. malware, unauthorized services) on an ordinary client workstation. Fails when the count exceeds 5.

[MEDIUM] **NET-013** **Excessive UDP Endpoints**

A large number of active UDP endpoints can indicate unexpected network activity (e.g. malware, unauthorized services) on an ordinary client workstation. Fails when the count exceeds 15.

[MEDIUM] **NET-014** **Excessive Open Ports**

A large number of open (listening) TCP ports increases network attack surface on an ordinary client workstation. Fails when the count exceeds 6.

Windows Update & Patch Management

4 checks

[HIGH] **UPD-001** **Windows Update Service Running**

The Windows Update service must be running for updates to be installed.

[MEDIUM] **UPD-002** **Days Since Last Installed Update**

A system that has not received updates recently may be missing important security patches. This checks installed-update recency as a local, offline-safe proxy; it does not query Microsoft's update catalog for pending updates (see FRAMEWORK.md).

[MEDIUM] **UPD-003** **Automatic Updates Not Paused**

Windows Update should not be left paused indefinitely, which silently stops patch installation. Checked via the Group Policy NoAutoUpdate override (hard disable) and, more relevantly on a modern consumer install, the PauseUpdatesExpiryTime value written by Settings > Windows Update > Pause updates. Confirmed live via direct registry access that this value is genuinely absent (not merely unset/null) when updates are not paused, making its presence a definite, current signal rather than a guess.

[INFO] **UPD-004** **Last Installed Update Date**

Report the date of the most recently installed update.

Services

5 checks

[CRITICAL] SVC-001 Firewall Service Running

The Windows Defender Firewall service (mpssvc) must be running for firewall rules to be enforced.

[CRITICAL] SVC-002 Defender Antivirus Service Running

The Windows Defender Antivirus service (WinDefend) must be running to enforce Defender's protections.

[MEDIUM] SVC-003 Remote Registry Service Disabled

The Remote Registry service allows remote editing of the registry and should be disabled unless centrally required.

[LOW] SVC-004 Print Spooler Service Running

The Print Spooler service has a history of privilege-escalation vulnerabilities (e.g. PrintNightmare); disable it on systems that do not print.

[INFO] SVC-005 Automatically Starting Services

Report all services configured to start automatically.

Processes & Applications

7 checks

[INFO] **APP-001** **Installed Applications Inventory**

Report installed applications, sourced from registry Uninstall keys (Win32_Product is intentionally avoided; querying it can trigger MSI consistency-check side effects, which conflicts with the read-only requirement).

[LOW] **APP-002** **Excessive Startup Entries**

A very large number of auto-starting programs increases attack surface and often indicates unmanaged software sprawl.

[INFO] **APP-003** **Running Processes**

Report currently running processes.

[MEDIUM] **APP-004** **Processes Running From Unusual Paths**

Processes executing from temporary or user-writable directories (e.g. %TEMP%, %APPDATA%) can indicate malware.

[INFO] **APP-005** **Unwanted/Risky Software Detected**

Report installed software commonly flagged for review: unmanaged remote-access clients (TeamViewer, AnyDesk), virtualization software (VMware, VirtualBox), and registry/system cleaner utilities. Informational: presence alone isn't a universal fail (e.g. VMware/VirtualBox are legitimate developer tools).

[INFO] **APP-006** **Installed Programs List**

Report every individually-registered MSI product/component on this system. Lower-level and noisier than the Installed Applications Inventory (APP-001) -- includes granular sub-packages (e.g. individual Visual Studio components) that never get a user-facing Uninstall entry.

[MEDIUM] **APP-007** **Excessive Installed Programs**

A very large number of installed programs increases attack surface and often indicates unmanaged software sprawl. Fails when the count exceeds 20.

Remote Access

4 checks

[HIGH] **RDP-001** **Remote Desktop Enabled**

Remote Desktop increases remote attack surface and should be disabled unless required.

[HIGH] **RDP-002** **RDP Requires Network Level Authentication**

When RDP is enabled, Network Level Authentication should be required to authenticate before a session is established.

[MEDIUM] **RDP-003** **Remote Assistance Enabled**

Remote Assistance should be disabled unless actively required for support sessions.

[MEDIUM] **RDP-004** **WinRM Service Running**

WinRM (remote management) should only be running when intentionally used, and restricted to trusted management hosts.

System Configuration & Policies

3 checks

[MEDIUM] POL-001 PowerShell Execution Policy

Unrestricted or Bypass execution policy removes a layer of protection against running untrusted scripts. The 'Process' scope is deliberately excluded from this check: this auditor invokes PowerShell with -ExecutionPolicy Bypass for its own commands, which would otherwise always show as a false 'Bypass' at Process scope regardless of the system's real persistent policy.

[LOW] POL-002 PowerShell Script Block Logging Enabled

Script block logging improves the ability to detect and investigate malicious PowerShell use.

[LOW] POL-003 Device Installation Restriction Policy Configured

Restricting installation of unauthorized device classes reduces risk from rogue peripherals.

Data & Storage Security

7 checks

[CRITICAL] STG-001 BitLocker Enabled on OS Drive

The operating system drive should be encrypted to protect data at rest if the device is lost or stolen.

[HIGH] STG-002 Fixed Drives Without BitLocker

All fixed data drives should be encrypted, not only the OS drive.

[MEDIUM] STG-003 Removable Drives Without BitLocker

Removable drives containing sensitive data should be encrypted with BitLocker To Go; this is reported as advisory since not all removable media holds sensitive data.

[MEDIUM] STG-004 Non-Default SMB Shares

Unnecessary SMB shares expand the network attack surface.

[LOW] STG-005 Unexpected Write Access on System Directories

Non-administrative accounts should not have write access to core system directories.

[INFO] STG-006 Shared Folders List

Report folders shared with other systems (excluding built-in administrative shares).

[MEDIUM] STG-007 Excessive Shared Folders

A large number of shared folders expands the network attack surface and increases exposure of local data to other systems. Fails when the count exceeds 3.

Event & Log Auditing

4 checks

[LOW] **LOG-001** **Security Log Size Adequate**

An undersized Security log rolls over quickly, losing evidence needed for incident investigation. Confirmed on a live Windows 11 system that even listing this log's metadata (not just reading entries) is denied without elevation.

[MEDIUM] **LOG-002** **Failed Logon Events (24h)**

A high number of failed logon attempts in a short window can indicate brute-force activity.

[HIGH] **LOG-003** **Logon Event Auditing Enabled**

Without logon auditing enabled, authentication activity cannot be reconstructed after an incident.

[LOW] **LOG-004** **System Log Available**

The System event log should be accessible for diagnosing system-level issues and changes.

Device & Peripheral Security

10 checks

[INFO] DEV-001 USB Storage Installation Policy State

Report whether USB mass-storage device installation is restricted. Reported informationally: whether restriction is appropriate is organization-specific.

[INFO] DEV-002 Connected USB Devices

Report currently attached USB devices.

[INFO] DEV-003 Bluetooth Adapter Present

Report whether a Bluetooth adapter is present and its state.

[INFO] DEV-004 Webcam Access Setting

Report the system-level camera privacy access setting.

[INFO] DEV-005 Microphone Access Setting

Report the system-level microphone privacy access setting.

[MEDIUM] DEV-006 Bluetooth Radio Disabled

Disabling the Bluetooth radio when not needed reduces wireless attack surface. Advisory: only evaluated when a Bluetooth adapter is present, and many systems legitimately need Bluetooth for peripherals.

[MEDIUM] DEV-007 USB Storage Device Connected

An attached USB mass-storage device is a data exfiltration and malware-introduction vector. Advisory: legitimate use (backups, transfers) is common, so this is a warning rather than a hard fail.

[MEDIUM] DEV-008 Webcam Access Allowed

Whether apps are permitted to access the camera. Advisory: many systems legitimately need camera access (video calls), so this is a warning rather than a hard fail.

[MEDIUM] DEV-009 Microphone Access Allowed

Whether apps are permitted to access the microphone. Advisory: many systems legitimately need microphone access (calls, dictation), so this is a warning rather than a hard fail.

[INFO] DEV-010 USB Storage Device History

Report USB mass-storage devices ever connected to this system (not just currently attached), with serial number, manufacturer, and first/last-used dates.

Browser & Internet Security

3 checks

[INFO] **BRW-001** **Installed Browsers Inventory**

Report installed browsers and their versions. Reported informationally only: this offline tool cannot check versions against the latest published release, so it does not assert up-to-date/outdated status (see FRAMEWORK.md limitations).

[MEDIUM] **BRW-002** **Edge SmartScreen Enabled**

SmartScreen in Microsoft Edge helps block malicious sites and downloads. Checked via the Edge policy registry override; if no policy is present, Edge does not persist this setting anywhere until changed from default (confirmed live, including a search of Edge's own Preferences JSON), so absence is reported as Microsoft's documented on-by-default state.

[LOW] **BRW-003** **Browser Proxy Override Configured**

An unexpected browser-level proxy override can indicate traffic interception.

Backup & Recovery

3 checks

[MEDIUM] BKP-001 System Restore Enabled

System Restore provides a rollback path after unwanted system changes. Checked via the DisableSR Group Policy override (hard disable, no elevation needed) and, when no policy is present, Get-ComputerRestorePoint: confirmed live that this cmdlet requires elevation and is documented to throw "System Restore is disabled on this computer" when protection is off system-wide, succeeding otherwise (even with zero existing restore points).

[INFO] BKP-002 Windows Backup Service State

Report the state of the Windows Backup service (SDRSVC). Reported informationally: presence of the service does not confirm an actual backup job exists.

[LOW] BKP-003 Recovery Partition Present

A Windows Recovery Environment (WinRE) partition supports system repair and recovery.